OceanX Logistics Pte. Ltd.
18 Harbourfront Quay, #24-01 Meridian Harbour Tower, Singapore 098631
www.oceanxlogistics.example

CUSTOMER POLICY · OX-CUS-003

Refund & Dispute Resolution Policy

Invoice disputes, refunds, credit notes and escalation

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Policy owner	Priya Raghunathan, Chief Financial Officer	**Approved by**	Sebastian Lindqvist, Chief Commercial Officer
Applies to	All OceanX customers and invoiced parties	**Classification**	Public

1. Purpose

OceanX aims to invoice correctly the first time. If something goes wrong, this policy explains how to dispute a charge, when you are entitled to a refund, and how disagreements are escalated.

2. What can be disputed

Dispute type	Examples	Deadline to raise
Rate dispute	Rate differs from quotation or service contract	30 days from invoice
Quantity / equipment	Wrong container count, size or type	30 days from invoice
Duplicate billing	Same charge invoiced twice	90 days from invoice
Demurrage & detention	Free time miscalculated; delay caused by the carrier	30 days from invoice
Surcharge applicability	BAF/PSS applied outside its validity period	30 days from invoice
Service failure	Rolled booking, missed transhipment, late equipment release	60 days from event

Cargo loss or damage is **not** handled under this policy. File a cargo claim under OX-CUS-007 Cargo Claims Policy.

3. How to raise a dispute

1. Log in to **OX Navigator > Billing > Dispute** and select the invoice line(s).

2. State the reason and the amount in dispute, and attach evidence (quotation, contract amendment, EIR, gate-in record).
3. You receive a case number immediately (format: `DSP-YYYY-NNNNNN`).
4. Pay the **undisputed** portion by the due date. Disputed amounts are put on hold from collection and late-payment interest.

4. Resolution timelines

Stage	Who	Target
Acknowledgement	Billing Desk	1 business day
Investigation & decision (standard)	Billing Desk	10 business days
Investigation & decision (complex, multi-party)	Regional Finance	25 business days
Credit note issued after approval	Billing Desk	3 business days

If a dispute is approved, OceanX issues a **credit note** against the original invoice. Credit notes may be applied to open invoices or refunded.

5. Refunds

5.1 Eligible refunds

- Overpayments and duplicate payments
- Approved disputes where the invoice was already paid
- Cancelled bookings where freight was prepaid (minus any cancellation fee under the Booking & Cancellation Policy)
- Container deposits (where applicable, e.g. India and China) after the equipment is returned in good condition

5.2 Refund process

- Refunds are paid to the **original paying account only**, in the original currency.
- A signed refund request on company letterhead is required for amounts above USD 10,000.
- Target payment: **15 business days** after approval (30 business days for China, due to SAFE documentation).
- Container deposit refunds in India: within 21 days of the EIR showing a clean return.

5.3 Non-refundable charges

Documentation fees for issued B/Ls, amendment fees after B/L issue, and government fees paid on the customer's behalf (customs duties, port dues) are not refundable by OceanX.

6. Escalation

If you are not satisfied with a dispute decision:

1. **Level 1 - Regional Finance Manager:** request a review within 15 days of the decision. Response within 10 business days.
2. **Level 2 - Customer Experience Ombudsperson** (ombuds@oceanxlogistics.example): an independent internal review. Response within 20 business days.
3. **Level 3 - Formal dispute resolution:** under the governing law and forum in the B/L or service contract. For US trades, customers may also contact the Federal Maritime Commission's Office of Consumer Affairs & Dispute Resolution Services (CADRS).

7. Demurrage & detention disputes (US trades)

In line with the US Ocean Shipping Reform Act 2022 (OSRA 2022) and 46 CFR Part 541, OceanX's US demurrage and detention invoices include all required information. They are issued within 30 days of the last charge, and disputes can be raised for at least 30 days after the invoice. Invoices that do not meet these requirements need not be paid.

8. Records

All disputes are logged and retained for 7 years. Monthly dispute statistics (volume, root cause, cycle time) are reviewed by the Commercial Excellence Committee to fix recurring billing errors.

OceanX Logistics is a fictional company created for AI training and demonstration. All names, addresses, vessels, registration numbers and figures are invented.